

LAXMIKANT ANILKUMAR BIRAJDAR

Phone: +91 98907-93155

Email: La.birajdar@outlook.com

LinkedIn: [Laxmikant@LinkedIn](#)

GitHub: [Laxmikant@Github](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Over 2 decades (23 years) of experience as a software professional with **12+ in the leadership roles while practicing several tools hands on**. Subject matter expert in **Quality engineering, Project and Program management** and have delivered projects **using Agile and Waterfall** models continuously improving practices and strategies. Delivered quality products by collaborating with Geographically distributed teams. Worked with some notable companies like **Persistent Systems, Dassault Systems, Icertis Software** gaining experience in **Services and Product Organizations**.

Managed Delivery, Release and Operations for Software projects, worked as **program manager** collaborating with cross functional teams. Co-Lead the innovations Practice, to cultivate and promote the innovations from the teams. **Closely worked with Customers** to get their software related issues resolved and with Vendors for recruiting the talent to work in staff augmented mode in the Offshore delivery model setup. Crafted and tracked **metrics to ensure and improve efficiency**, productivity and quality of the product deploying left shift concepts of Software development.

Actively researched and used AI and ML tools for the benefit of projects and to operate at the optimal efficiency level reducing wasted efforts in mundane tasks. Explored and **evaluated different AI tools** serving different purposes of software development life cycle.

Collaborated with major clients such as **Intuit (Personal Finance), CLS Bank (Forex Settlement), Medidata (Clinical Trial Management), Openwave (Telecom)** working in both **onsite and offshore** model. At **Gooru Learning (Edutech)** contributed to design, develop, **test and implement the learning navigator**.

An advocate and active practitioner of test automation, have hands on experience with **Selenium (with Java), Robot Framework, Cypress, Silk Test, WinRunner, Postman etc. and contributed to open-source community the script-less test automation framework**. Contributed to API testing using tools such as Postman, SOAP, JMeter and have integrated automation with **continuous integration and delivery** tools such as Jenkins, Bamboo.

As a **Techno-manager** have **managed** sizeable **multi-level teams** up to 30 direct reports, setting up quality and engineering teams from scratch, including recruiting, onboarding, training, performance reviews. **Acted as a bridge** between the customers and the delivery teams. Participated in go-no-go decision meetings while managing defect **allocation & prioritization**.

SKILLS

Quality engineering – Product lifecycle, Test lifecycle, Defect Lifecycle and Release Lifecycle

Test Automation – Selenium, Robot Framework, Cypress, Winrunner, Silk Test, Postman, Appium, JMeter, TestNG

API Testing, Web Testing, Mobile App Testing

Software Programming – Java, Object Oriented Programming, Database concepts, SQL Queries
Manual Testing – Planning and Strategizing for Regression, Smoke, Alpha, Beta and Customer reported issues
Written and Verbal Communication skills
Analytical, Reasoning and Problem-solving skills
Agile Development – Sprint Planning, Retrospectives, Scrum Meetings, Backlogs
People and project management (Agile and Waterfall)
Well versed with CI/CD, Jenkins, Bamboo, Git

EXPERIENCE

Icertis Solutions Pvt. Ltd, Pune

as a Associate Director - Quality Engineering

From: Nov 2022 – To: Aug 2024

Icertis is leading provider of **Contract Lifecycle Management Software**, providing it in a **SaaS** (Software as a Service) model on **Microsoft Azure** to enterprise customers.

Leading a **28-member, multi-level** team, responsible for ensuring quality of **core platform multiple modules** of a **SaaS** application developed for Contract Management. Strategizing for Resource Needs (**people, tools**), Infrastructure Needs (**on-premises, cloud**), Defining Testing Types (**smoke, regression, alpha, beta**) and adopting Methodology to be deployed to ensure the end-to-end product quality.

As a project and program manager, demonstrated the strong abilities of working with cross functional teams to gather requirements, understand priorities, break down the work and plan the backlog and releases.

Tracked the project deliverables and course corrected where needed to meet the committed deadlines.

Working with **cross-functional** teams which include Product, Quality, Devops and Release Management to deliver the quality product in a timely manner adhering to the commitments.

Set a model for **testing on customer like environments (in cloud)** to catch the defects in early cycle, **reducing at least 50% of configuration and deployment related issues** over the time.

Deployed **distributed and multi environment model** of testing to **eliminate the downtime** due to issues of any kind during the productive hours of testing saving **several hours of otherwise wasted time**.

Advocated for **automation** and increased the automation coverage. **Reviewed the automated tests** for their completeness and provided the inputs needed from time to time. Made use of automated tests to ensure the **consistent quality** of builds delivered to test teams. Placed the **controls in place** for ensuring **no-gaps between manual and automated** test counts/coverage. Used the automation to **free up QA bandwidth** to do more **focused and exploratory testing** to uncover the defects.

Active participation in the requirement, planning and release discussions to **effectively understand** and **translate the requirements** to the test members. **Wrote, Reviewed and Guided writing** of the **test cases** considering possible customer scenarios and personas. Experimented and **evaluated** the tools for **browser compatibility tests**. Incorporated **continuous review and feedback** model to **improve the test coverage** and **reduce the defect leakage**. Seeded the **habit of creating and reviewing the metrics to measure and improve** the **progress, efficiency of the team** and quality of the product. **Actively worked** with the team to **understand customer reported issues** and deliver them the solutions in terms of hot fixes and patch releases.

Tools and Skills used:

Agile Project Management, Communication, Quality Engineering, Selenium, Jira, Lambda Test, Git workflows, Microsoft Azure.

Dassault Systemes Private Limited, Pune

as Senior R& D Quality Manager

From: Aug 2020 – To: Nov 2022

Worked for **Medidata**, an **acquisition by Dassault Systemes**. Medidata is a leading provider of **data analytics and solutions that support clinical research**. It has products that enhance and modernize Clinical Trial Efficiency and Patient Experience.

Lead a multi-level team of QA leaders and engineers working on different projects serving the phases of **Clinical Trial Management Software products**. Primary responsibility being the assessment and validation of **Core Platform components**. Complete ownership of **reviewing and certifying** the test artifacts such as **operational qualifications for clinical compliance**. Worked **closely with US counterparts** to plan, define, implement and deliver the product requirements in a continuous delivery manner. **Setup the test automation** from scratch and handhold the **team of architects** and engineers to develop a scalable automation framework **using Robot Framework**. Worked closely with automation architect to provide and upgrade the framework for various project needs from time to time, e.g. **Centralized repository vs. decentralized repository**. **Mentored the existing in-house** talent to shoulder additional responsibility, **motivated team members** by constantly rewarding and recognizing the good work.

Tools and Skills used:

Agile Project Management, Communication, Quality Engineering, Selenium, Jira, Robot Framework

Gooru India Foundation for Learning Innovation, Pune

as Senior Technical Consultant

From: May 2020 – To: Jun 2020

Gooru provides a learning navigator suggesting and creating customized learning paths for the users using power of Artificial Intelligence (AI).

During this phase of association with Gooru, worked as a consultant to Identify, Prioritize and direct the **Implementation of test automation** using **Selenium and Postman** for **APIs, Web Application and Android Apps**. Also, to assist with **release process** and **customer enablement**.

as Quality Engineering Manager

From: Mar 2017 – To: Apr 2020

During these 3 years, worked in a **startup**, fast-growing, **aggressively demanding mode**. At first, **setup the QA team** of engineers by **researching, recruiting and onboarding the talent**. Contributed to all the product requirement discussions, shaping the product. During the early phases, **met with the customers in India and USA** to demonstrate the product and seek feedback and suggestions. Actively translated suggestions and pain points into user stories for the leadership to review and prioritize.

Defined **strategy to test**, **strategy to automate** the tests and **strategy to release the product** with minimum or no impact to quality. **Used Selenium to develop the base framework** and **UI tests** to get going with the automation. Used **JMeter to simulate classroom like environment** to conduct the assessment and view the live results.

For some schools, **acted as point of contact** and helped them to **onboard on Gooru**. Helped resolve their early queries and any issues they faced while using **Gooru, the navigator, or the live dashboards**.

Persistent Systems Limited, Pune

as individual contributor/Leader/manager role

From: Mar 2001 – To: Mar 2017

Persistent is a multinational **technology services** company based out of Pune.

Started the career with **Persistent** as a **Software Test Engineer** learning the lessons of Software Quality and Product Lifecycle. **Utilized Java programming skills** to understand the implementations and **sometimes to discover defects** as well. Took the **early lessons of test automation** by practising different automation tools such as **WinRunner, Silk Test, Rational Robot** etc. **on live projects** as per the customer need.

While providing Testing services different customers, **utilized the opportunity** of learning **new domains** which included **Telecom** (Openwave), **Finance and Forex Settlement** (CLS Bank), **Personal Finance and Agriculture** (Intuit), **Healthcare and Life Sciences** (Cardinal Health, Applied Biosystems) etc.

Grew with Persistent's growth and was **promoted at regular intervals** to perform the demanding roles as Test Lead, Test Architect, Test Manager etc. wearing different hats and contributing to the required capacity.

Played a key role during setting up the **Centre of Excellence** for Innovation, **organized internal events and hackathons** to promote and motivate the developers to **build the apps** with intention to promote the innovation culture.

EDUCATION

Government College of Engineering, Pune

From: Aug 1996 – To: Jul 2000

Bachelor of Engineering (Production Engineering) with Distinction